

# PROJECT PLANNING PHASE

Salesforce CRM Application | Planning, Backlog & Sprint Scheduling

## 5.1 Project Planning

The CRM project followed an **Agile-based development approach** with defined milestones and sprints. Planning focused on building a structured Salesforce environment, modeling business data, automating routine activities, and delivering useful reports and dashboards within the planned timeline.

| #  | Planning Area     | Planned Activity                                                                  |
|----|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 01 | Development Setup | Create the Salesforce Developer environment and prepare the project workspace.    |
| 02 | Data Modeling     | Design Customer, Employer and Enterprise objects, fields, relationships and tabs. |
| 03 | Configuration     | Configure page layouts, record types, picklists and validation rules.             |
| 04 | Automation        | Develop email templates, flows and automated billing/notification processes.      |
| 05 | Analytics         | Build reports and dashboards for sales, customer and enterprise monitoring.       |
| 06 | Sprint Review     | Test each increment, review progress, resolve issues and track completion.        |

### Planning Principles

- **Incremental delivery:** functionality was organized into manageable sprints.
- **Data consistency:** fields, relationships, picklists and validation rules were planned before automation.
- **User-focused design:** layouts, record types and navigation were aligned with different CRM users.
- **Continuous review:** sprint reviews and testing were used to identify and resolve issues early.

### Planned Outcome

A scalable Salesforce CRM environment capable of managing customer, employer and enterprise information while supporting orders, billing, automated communication, reporting and dashboard-based analysis.

## PRODUCT BACKLOG & SPRINT SCHEDULE

The backlog translates the project requirements into user stories. Story points indicate relative effort, while priority identifies the order in which work should be addressed.

| Sprint   | Epic            | USN    | User Story / Task                                                                         | Points | Priority | Owner    |
|----------|-----------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|----------|----------|
| Sprint-1 | Developer Setup | USN-1  | Create a Salesforce developer account to configure and deploy the CRM application.        | 1      | High     | Member 1 |
| Sprint-1 | Data Modeling   | USN-2  | Create Customer, Employer and Enterprise objects for systematic business data management. | 3      | High     | Member 2 |
| Sprint-2 | Data Modeling   | USN-3  | Create separate tabs for each object for easier CRM navigation.                           | 3      | High     | Member 3 |
| Sprint-2 | Data Modeling   | USN-4  | Create a dedicated Lightning App so CRM operations are accessible from one place.         | 3      | High     | Member 4 |
| Sprint-2 | Data Modeling   | USN-5  | Create customer and order fields to capture sales and billing details accurately.         | 5      | Medium   | Member 1 |
| Sprint-2 | Data Modeling   | USN-6  | Customize page layouts for different record types and relevant data-entry needs.          | 5      | High     | Member 2 |
| Sprint-2 | Data Modeling   | USN-7  | Create separate Retail and Enterprise record types for business categories.               | 5      | Medium   | Member 3 |
| Sprint-3 | Automation      | USN-8  | Validate customer details and order inputs to prevent incorrect data entries.             | 3      | High     | Member 4 |
| Sprint-3 | Automation      | USN-9  | Create automated flows for email notifications, updates and offers.                       | 5      | High     | Member 1 |
| Sprint-4 | Automation      | USN-10 | Automatically calculate billing amounts so invoices require less manual effort.           | 5      | High     | Member 2 |
| Sprint-5 | Reports         | USN-11 | Create sales and customer reports for business-performance monitoring.                    | 4      | High     | Member 3 |
| Sprint-6 | Dashboards      | USN-12 | Create visual dashboards to analyze sales, customers and enterprise performance.          | 4      | Medium   | Member 4 |

### Backlog Structure

The backlog moves from environment setup and data modeling toward automation and analytics. This sequence reduces dependency issues because reporting and dashboards are built after the underlying CRM data and processes are established.

## PROJECT TRACKER & SPRINT CONTROL

The sprint tracker provides a compact view of planned effort, timing and completion. The original schedule defines six sprints in the backlog, while the tracker below records the first four sprint windows supplied in the project plan.

| Sprint   | Story Points | Duration | Start Date  | Planned End | Completed | Actual Release |
|----------|--------------|----------|-------------|-------------|-----------|----------------|
| Sprint-1 | 20           | 6 Days   | 24 Oct 2022 | 29 Oct 2022 | 20        | 29 Oct 2022    |
| Sprint-2 | 20           | 6 Days   | 31 Oct 2022 | 05 Nov 2022 | —         | —              |
| Sprint-3 | 20           | 6 Days   | 07 Nov 2022 | 12 Nov 2022 | —         | —              |
| Sprint-4 | 20           | 6 Days   | 14 Nov 2022 | 19 Nov 2022 | —         | —              |

### Sprint Lifecycle

| PLAN                             | BUILD               | TEST                      | REVIEW                   | RELEASE                     |
|----------------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Select stories & estimate effort | Configure & develop | Validate behaviour & data | Review progress & issues | Deliver completed increment |

### Estimation & Velocity

Story points provide a relative measure of work rather than a direct time estimate. As sprints progress, completed story points can be used to observe team velocity and improve future planning.

### Burndown Tracking

A burndown chart can plot remaining story points against the sprint timeline. A downward trend toward zero indicates progress toward the planned sprint scope.

## PLANNING SUMMARY

### From Requirements to Delivery

The planning phase converts CRM requirements into an organized development roadmap. It establishes what needs to be built, who owns each user story, how much effort is expected, and when each increment is scheduled.

#### REQUIREMENTS

Functional needs are converted into user stories and measurable tasks.

#### SCHEDULE

Work is grouped into sprints with planned start and end dates.

#### OWNERSHIP

Each story is assigned to a team member for accountability.

#### QUALITY

Testing and sprint reviews are included throughout development.

### Key Deliverables

- Salesforce development environment
- Customer, Employer and Enterprise data model
- Custom tabs, Lightning App, fields and relationships
- Page layouts, record types and global picklists
- Validation rules, email templates and automated flows
- Reports and dashboards for CRM analysis

#### Planning Phase Complete

The project plan establishes a clear path from setup and data modeling to automation, reporting and dashboard delivery.